LESSON 6

Twinkle, Twinkle

An old French tune that Mozart loved: he wrote twelve variations on it, the same tune twelve new ways. The words are Jane Taylor's, from 1806.

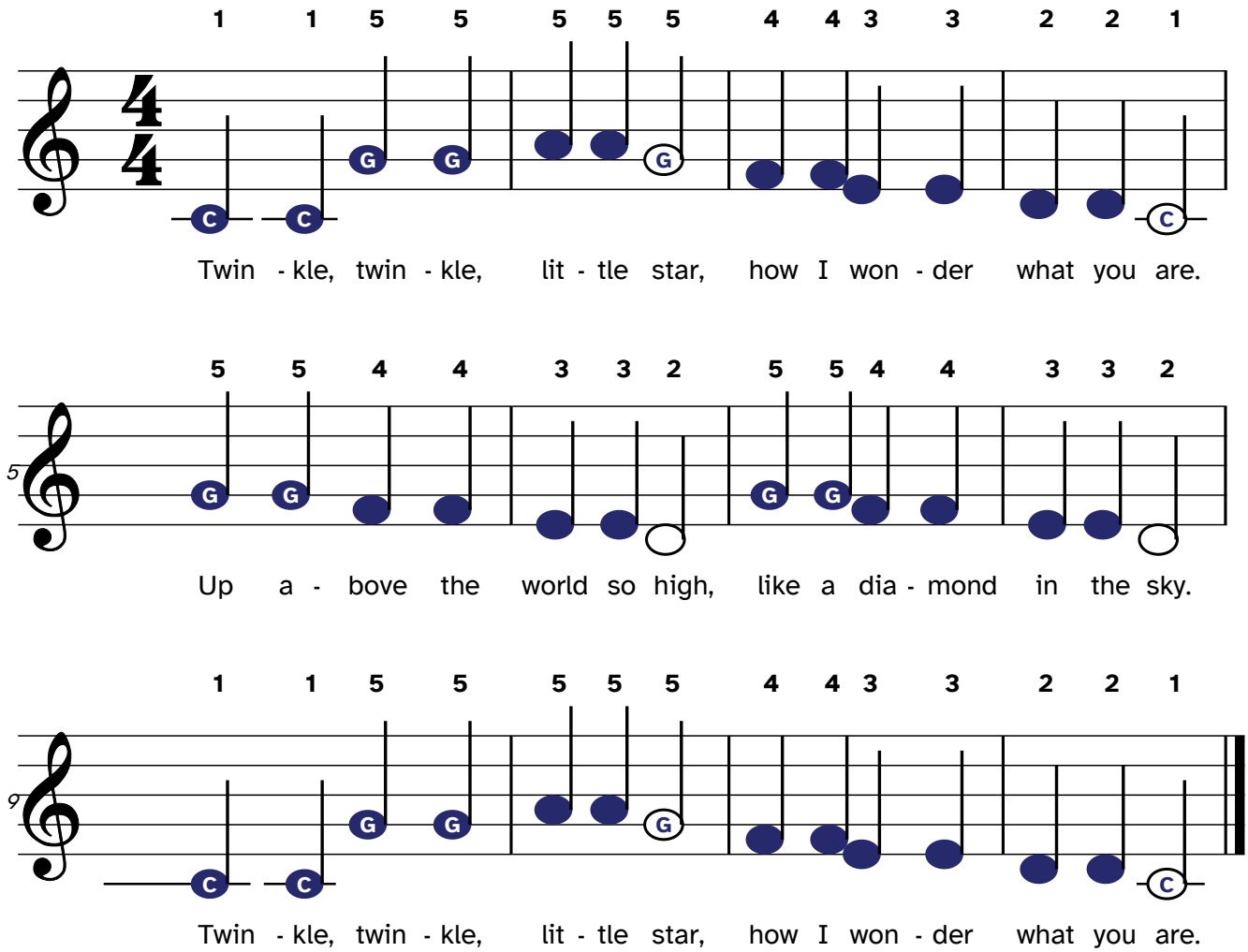
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Be Mozart:** he played this tune twelve ways. Play it as written, then every note twice: *twin-kle-twin-kle*.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words.

Your hand: the C position. On *little*, 5 reaches up to A and comes home to G. Only C and G keep their letters.

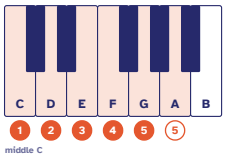


- [ ] **Listened and pointed**
- [ ] **Sang it with the words**
- [ ] **Found the stretch to A**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

C POSITION · 5 REACHES TO A



NEW IN THIS SONG

5 reaches to A. The hand stays in the C position; the little finger stretches one key up, to A, and comes home to G.

More in the Handbook: Pitch 1 and 2, for the note A

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

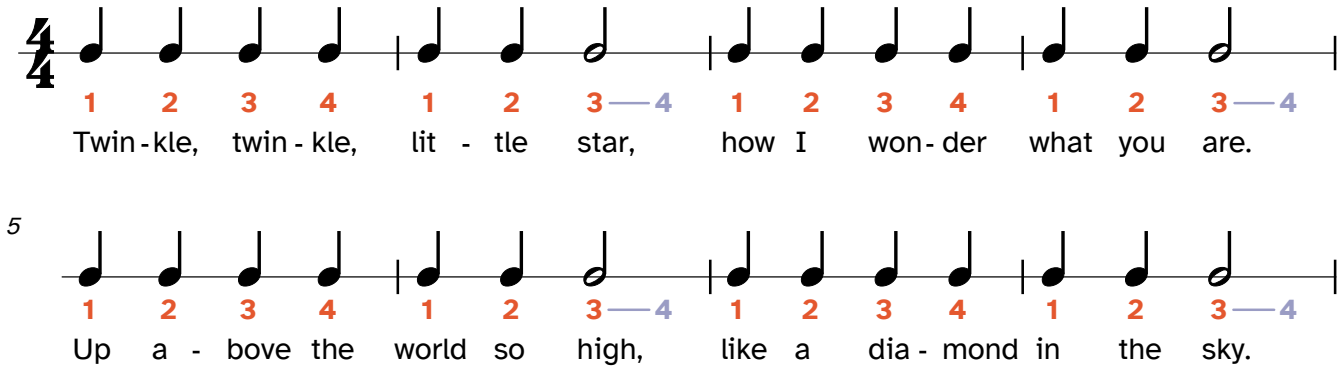
Top 4: four beats in every bar.

Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

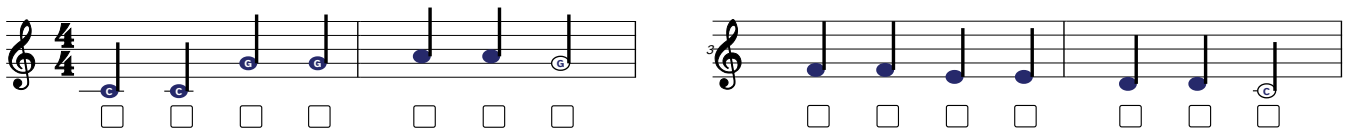
crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

Only C and G are named. Write the others under their notes: count up or down from C and G, and find the new A.



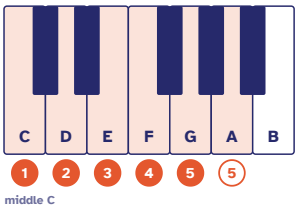
SPOT THE MISTAKE — Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

3 Play it

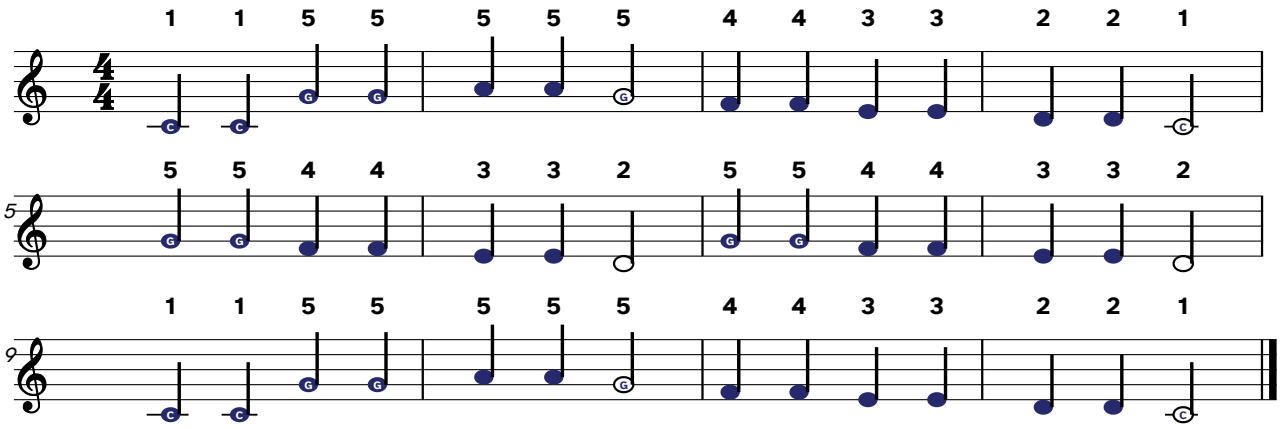
The right hand plays it all, 5 reaching to A; the left hand plays line 1, an octave lower.

C POSITION · 5 REACHES TO A

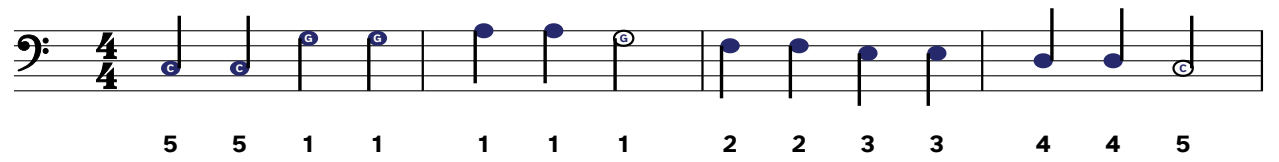


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 to 5 up to G; 5 stretches to A.
Left hand: an octave lower, on the King's staff: thumb on G, down to 5 on C; the thumb stretches to A.

R RIGHT HAND the whole song



L LEFT HAND line 1, the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can reach 5 up to A

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

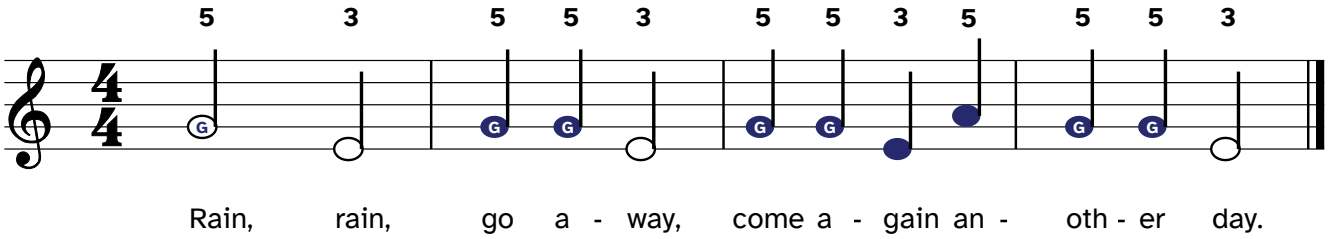
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways: the rain rhyme, then hands that take turns, a peek at Lesson 7.

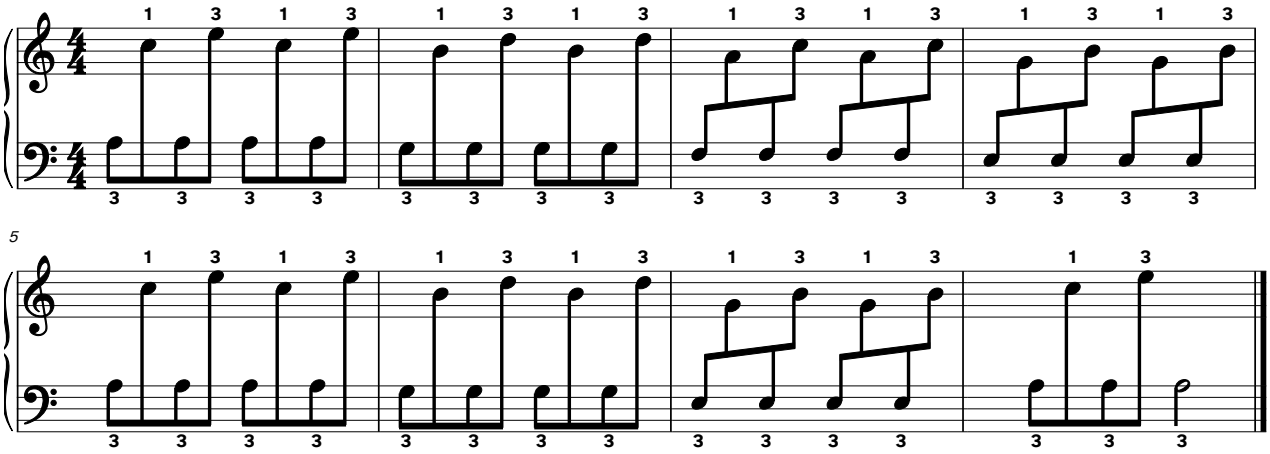
RAIN, RAIN, GO AWAY

The old rhyme to send the rain away: G and E, and 5 reaching to A on *an-other*.



FALLING LEAVES

Gentle and swaying. Hands take turns; the right hand keeps one shape (thumb and 3); each bar, both hands step down a key.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Mozart's way: every note twice, twin-kle-twin-kle**
- ☐ **Dreamy: slow and soft, with the harp**
- ☐ **Heartbeat: the left hand taps low C on beat 1 of every bar**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Lines 1 and 2, twice
3. The whole song, twice
4. One variation of your own

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Rain, Rain** ☐ **Played Falling Leaves**